# NATIONAL YOUTH LEADERSHIP TRAINING (NYLT) COURSE

2021 Edition (with 2024 updates)

# SYLLABUS

National Youth Leadership Training (NYLT) is a training program developed, owned, and authorized by the National Council, Scouting America. Local councils serve as the representative of the National Council in conducting this program in accordance with these policies and procedures. It is the duty of the local council to promote NYLT as a part of the Scouting program and to provide leadership and support to deliver NYLT in a manner that is consistent and ensures compliance with the policies, procedures, direction and support material contained herein. Consistent delivery of the NYLT program nationwide is an expectation of all courses.

**Leadership for Scouting—Leadership for America**

Scouting America

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# National Youth Leadership Training – Weeklong Format (2021 Edition)

| | Day 1 | Day 2 | Day 3 | Day 4 | Day 5 | Day 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Stages of Team Development | Forming = TG Leadership Behaviors – Explaining | | | | | |
| | Storming = TG Leadership Behaviors – Demonstrating | | | | | |
| | | | Norming = TG Leadership Behaviors – Guiding | | | |
| | | | | | Performing = TG Leadership Behaviors – Enabling | |
| Module Delivery | Communicating #1 | Communicating #2 | Communicating #3 | Communicating #4 | Communicating #5 | Communicating #6 |
| | Finding Your Vision | Setting Your Goals | Solving Problems | Servant Leadership | Diversity and Valuing People | Embracing and Leading Change |
| | | Planning | Developing Your Team | Leading Yourself | Resolving Conflicts | Resilience |
| | | | Scouting EDGE | Ethics and Values in Decision-making | | |
| 6:30 AM | | Breakfast | Breakfast | Breakfast | Breakfast | Breakfast and Return from Outpost Camp |
| 6:45 AM | | | | | | |
| 7:00 AM | | | | | | |
| 7:15 AM | | | | | | |
| 7:30 AM | | | | | | |
| 7:45 AM | | | | | | |
| 8:00 AM | | Troop Assembly | Troop Assembly | Troop Assembly | Troop Assembly | Troop Assembly |
| 8:15 AM | | | | | | |
| 8:30 AM | | Communicating #2 | Communicating #3 | Communicating #4 | Communicating #5 | Communicating #6 |
| 8:45 AM | | | | | | |
| 9:00 AM | | Setting Your Goals | Solving Problems | Servant Leadership | Diversity and Valuing People | Embracing and Leading Change |
| 9:15 AM | | | | | | |
| 9:30 AM | | | | | | |
| 9:45 AM | | | Solving Problems Round-robin | | | PLC Meeting |
| 10:00 AM | | Model Patrol Meeting | | "Styles of Leadership" Games | "The Hidden Diversity Within Us" Game | |
| 10:15 AM | | | | | | Patrol Meeting |
| 10:30 AM | | Planning | Developing Your Team | Leading Yourself | Resolving Conflicts | |
| 10:45 AM | | | | | | |
| 11:00 AM | | | | | | Resilience |
| 11:15 AM | | | | | | |
| 11:30 AM | | Model PLC Meeting | PLC Meeting | PLC Meeting | PLC Meeting | |
| 11:45 AM | | | | | | |
| 12:00 PM | Registration | Lunch | Lunch | Lunch | Lunch | Lunch |
| 12:15 PM | | | | | | |
| 12:30 PM | | | | | | |
| 12:45 PM | | | | | | |
| 1:00 PM | Orientation Trail | Model Troop Meeting | Patrol Meeting | Patrol Meeting | Patrol Meeting | Unit Issues Problem-solving Panel |
| 1:15 PM | | | | | | |
| 1:30 PM | | | Patrol Games Challenge | Patrol Games Challenge | Patrol Games Challenge | |
| 1:45 PM | | | | | | |
| 2:00 PM | Campsite Setup | | Troop Meeting | Troop Meeting | Outpost Camp Troop Assembly | Patrol Presentations (Quest for the Meaning of Leadership) |
| 2:15 PM | | | | | | |
| 2:30 PM | | | | | | |
| 2:45 PM | | *Transition Time* | | | | |
| 3:00 PM | | Team Project (Building Pioneering Projects) | | | | Camp Breakdown and Feast Preparation |
| 3:15 PM | Opening Troop Assembly | | | | | |
| 3:30 PM | | | Scouting EDGE | Interpatrol Activity (Geocaching) | | |
| 3:45 PM | Communicating #1 | | | | | |
| 4:00 PM | | | | | | |
| 4:15 PM | Finding Your Vision | | | | | |
| 4:30 PM | | | Patrol Activity | | | Feast |
| 4:45 PM | Expectations for NYLT Staff and Participant Conduct | | | | | |
| 5:00 PM | | *Transition Time* | | *Transition Time* | | |
| 5:15 PM | Dinner | Dinner | Dinner | Dinner | Outpost Camp | |
| 5:30 PM | | | | | | |
| 5:45 PM | | | | | | |
| 6:00 PM | | | | | | Closing Event |
| 6:15 PM | | | | | | |
| 6:30 PM | | | | | | |
| 6:45 PM | | | | | | |
| 7:00 PM | Flag Ceremony | Flag Ceremony | Flag Ceremony | Flag Ceremony | | |
| 7:15 PM | "Getting To Know You" Team Games | Movie Night and Reflection | LEGO® Challenge and Realistic First Aid | Model Scouts' Own Worship Service | | |
| 7:30 PM | | | | | | |
| 7:45 PM | | | | *Transition Time* | | |
| 8:00 PM | | | | Ethics and Values in Decision-making | | |
| 8:15 PM | Model Campfire | | | | | |
| 8:30 PM | | | | | | |
| 8:45 PM | | | Time for Cracker Barrel | | | |
| 9:00 PM | | | | Patrol Campfires | | |
| 9:15 PM | Cracker Barrel and Songfest | | | | | |
| 9:30 PM | | | | | | |
| 9:45 PM | | | | | | |
| 10:00 PM | Lights Out | Lights Out | Lights Out | Lights Out | Lights Out | |


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# National Youth Leadership Training – Two-Weekend Format (2021 Edition)

| | Day 1 | Day 2 | Day 3 | | Day 4 | Day 5 | Day 6 | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Stages of Team Development | Forming = TG Leadership Behaviors – Explaining | | | | | | | Stages of Team Development |
| | Storming = TG Leadership Behaviors – Demonstrating | | | | | | | |
| | | | Norming = TG Leadership Behaviors – Guiding | | | | | |
| | | | | | | Performing = TG Leadership Behaviors – Enabling | | |
| Module Delivery | Communicating #1 | Communicating #2 | Developing Your Team | | Communicating #4 | Ethics and Values in Decision-making | Communicating #6 | Module Delivery |
| | Finding Your Vision | Setting Your Goals | Scouting EDGE | | Servant Leadership | Communicating #5 | Embracing and Leading Change | |
| | | Planning | | | Leading Yourself | Diversity and Valuing People | Resilience | |
| | | Communicating #3 | | | | Resolving Conflicts | | |
| | | Solving Problems | | | | | | |
| 6:30 AM | | Breakfast | Breakfast | | | Breakfast | Breakfast and Return from Outpost Camp | 6:30 AM |
| 6:45 AM | | | | | | | | 6:45 AM |
| 7:00 AM | | | | | | | | 7:00 AM |
| 7:15 AM | | | | | | | | 7:15 AM |
| 7:30 AM | | Troop Asssembly | Troop Asssembly | | | Troop Asssembly | | 7:30 AM |
| 7:45 AM | | | | | | | Troop Asssembly | 7:45 AM |
| 8:00 AM | | Communicating #2 | Developing Your Team | | | Interpatrol Activity (Geocaching) | | 8:00 AM |
| 8:15 AM | | | | | | | Communicating #6 | 8:15 AM |
| 8:30 AM | | Setting Your Goals | | | | | | 8:30 AM |
| 8:45 AM | | | | | | | Patrol Games Challenge | 8:45 AM |
| 9:00 AM | | | PLC Meeting | | | | | 9:00 AM |
| 9:15 AM | | | | | | | Embracing and Leading Change | 9:15 AM |
| 9:30 AM | | Model Patrol Meeting | Patrol Games Challenge | | | Ethics and Values in Decision-making | | 9:30 AM |
| 9:45 AM | | | | | | | | 9:45 AM |
| 10:00 AM | | Planning | Troop Meeting | | | | PLC Meeting | 10:00 AM |
| 10:15 AM | | | | | | | | 10:15 AM |
| 10:30 AM | | | | | | Patrol Ethics Reflection ("Patrol Campfires") | Resilience | 10:30 AM |
| 10:45 AM | | | | | | | | 10:45 AM |
| 11:00 AM | | Model PLC Meeting | | | | Patrol Games Challenge | | 11:00 AM |
| 11:15 AM | | | | | | | | 11:15 AM |
| 11:30 AM | | Lunch | Lunch | | | Lunch | Feast | 11:30 AM |
| 11:45 AM | | | | | | | | 11:45 AM |
| 12:00 PM | | | | | | | | 12:00 PM |
| 12:15 PM | | | | | | | | 12:15 PM |
| 12:30 PM | | Model Troop Meeting | Patrol Meeting | | | Communicating #5 | | 12:30 PM |
| 12:45 PM | | | | | | | | 12:45 PM |
| 1:00 PM | | | Scouting EDGE | | | PLC Meeting | Patrol Meeting | 1:00 PM |
| 1:15 PM | | | | | | | | 1:15 PM |
| 1:30 PM | | | | | | Diversity and Valuing People | | 1:30 PM |
| 1:45 PM | | | | | | | Unit Issues Problem-solving Panel | 1:45 PM |
| 2:00 PM | | *Transition Time* | Patrol Activity | | | | | 2:00 PM |
| 2:15 PM | | Team Project (Building Pioneering Projects) | | | | | | 2:15 PM |
| 2:30 PM | | | | | | "The Hidden Diversity Within Us" Game | | 2:30 PM |
| 2:45 PM | | | LEGO® Challenge and Realistic First Aid | | | | Patrol Presentations (Quest for the Meaning of Leadership) | 2:45 PM |
| 3:00 PM | | | | | | Resolving Conflicts | | 3:00 PM |
| 3:15 PM | | | | | | | | 3:15 PM |
| 3:30 PM | | | | | | | | 3:30 PM |
| 3:45 PM | | | | | | | Camp Breakdown | 3:45 PM |
| 4:00 PM | | | | | | Patrol Meeting | | 4:00 PM |
| 4:15 PM | | *Transition Time* | Time for Cracker Barrel or Pack-up | | | | | 4:15 PM |
| 4:30 PM | Registration | Communicating #3 | | | Participant Check-In | Outpost Camp Troop Assembly | Closing Event | 4:30 PM |
| 4:45 PM | | | | | | | | 4:45 PM |
| 5:00 PM | Orientation Trail | Dinner | Weekend Closing Assembly | | | Outpost Camp | | 5:00 PM |
| 5:15 PM | | | | | Troop Asssembly | | | 5:15 PM |
| 5:30 PM | Campsite Setup | | | | | | | 5:30 PM |
| 5:45 PM | | | | | Communicating #4 | | | 5:45 PM |
| 6:00 PM | Opening Troop Assembly | Solving Problems | | | | | | 6:00 PM |
| 6:15 PM | | | | | PLC Meeting | | | 6:15 PM |
| 6:30 PM | Communicating #1 | | | | Servant Leadership | | | 6:30 PM |
| 6:45 PM | | Solving Problems Round-robin | | | | | | 6:45 PM |
| 7:00 PM | Finding Your Vision | | | | | | | 7:00 PM |
| 7:15 PM | | | | | | | | 7:15 PM |
| 7:30 PM | Expectations for NYLT Staff and Participant Conduct | Model Scouts' Own Worship Service | | | "Styles of Leadership" Games | | | 7:30 PM |
| 7:45 PM | | | | | | | | 7:45 PM |
| 8:00 PM | "Getting to Know You" Team Games | Movie Night and Reflection | | | Leading Yourself | | | 8:00 PM |
| 8:15 PM | | | | | | | | 8:15 PM |
| 8:30 PM | | | | | | | | 8:30 PM |
| 8:45 PM | | | | | | | | 8:45 PM |
| 9:00 PM | Model Campfire | | | | Troop Meeting | | | 9:00 PM |
| 9:15 PM | | | | | | | | 9:15 PM |
| 9:30 PM | | | | | | | | 9:30 PM |
| 9:45 PM | | | | | | | | 9:45 PM |
| 10:00 PM | Cracker Barrel and Song Fest | | | | | | | 10:00 PM |
| 10:15 PM | | | | | | | | 10:15 PM |
| 10:30 PM | Lights Out | Lights Out | | | Lights Out | Lights Out | | 10:30 PM |

## National Youth Leadership Training – Two-Weekend 4x2 Format (2021 Edition)

| | Day 1 | Day 2 | Day 3 | Day 4 | Day 5 | Day 6 | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Stages of Team Development | Forming = TG Leadership Behaviors – Explaining | | | | | | Stages of Team Development |
| | Storming = TG Leadership Behaviors – Demonstrating | | | | | | |
| | | | Norming = TG Leadership Behaviors – Guiding | | | | |
| | | | | | Performing = TG Leadership Behaviors – Enabling | | |
| Module Delivery | Communicating #1 | Communicating #2 | Communicating #3 | Communicating #4 | Communicating #5 | Communicating #6 | Module Delivery |
| | Finding Your Vision | Setting Your Goals | Solving Problems | Servant Leadership | Ethics and Values in Decision-making | Embracing and Leading Change | |
| | | Planning | Developing Your Team | Leading Yourself | Diversity and Valuing People | Resilience | |
| | | | Scouting EDGE | | Resolving Conflicts | | |
| 6:30 AM | | Breakfast | Breakfast | Breakfast | | Breakfast and Return from Outpost Camp | 6:30 AM |
| 6:45 AM | | | | | | | 6:45 AM |
| 7:00 AM | | | | | | | 7:00 AM |
| 7:15 AM | | | | | | | 7:15 AM |
| 7:30 AM | | | | | Participant Check-In | | 7:30 AM |
| 7:45 AM | | | | | | | 7:45 AM |
| 8:00 AM | | Troop Assembly | Troop Assembly | Troop Assembly | Troop Assembly | Troop Assembly | 8:00 AM |
| 8:15 AM | | | | | | | 8:15 AM |
| 8:30 AM | | Communicating #2 | Communicating #3 | Communicating #4 | Interpatrol Activity (Geocaching) | Communicating #6 | 8:30 AM |
| 8:45 AM | | | | | | | 8:45 AM |
| 9:00 AM | | Setting Your Goals | Solving Problems | Servant Leadership | | Embracing and Leading Change | 9:00 AM |
| 9:15 AM | | | | | | | 9:15 AM |
| 9:30 AM | | | | | | | 9:30 AM |
| 9:45 AM | | | Solving Problems Round-robin | | | PLC Meeting | 9:45 AM |
| 10:00 AM | | Model Patrol Meeting | | "Styles of Leadership" Games | Communicating #5 | | 10:00 AM |
| 10:15 AM | | | | | | Patrol Meeting | 10:15 AM |
| 10:30 AM | | Planning | Developing Your Team | Leading Yourself | Ethics and Values in Decision-making | | 10:30 AM |
| 10:45 AM | | | | | | | 10:45 AM |
| 11:00 AM | | | | | | Resilience | 11:00 AM |
| 11:15 AM | | | | | | | 11:15 AM |
| 11:30 AM | | Model PLC Meeting | PLC Meeting | PLC Meeting | Patrol Ethics Reflection (Patrol Campfires) | | 11:30 AM |
| 11:45 AM | | | | | | | 11:45 AM |
| 12:00 PM | | Lunch | Lunch | Lunch | Lunch and PLC Meeting | Feast | 12:00 PM |
| 12:15 PM | | | | | | | 12:15 PM |
| 12:30 PM | | | | | | | 12:30 PM |
| 12:45 PM | | | | | | | 12:45 PM |
| 1:00 PM | | Model Troop Meeting | Patrol Meeting | Patrol Meeting | Diversity and Valuing People | Unit Issues Problem-solving Panel | 1:00 PM |
| 1:15 PM | | | | | | | 1:15 PM |
| 1:30 PM | | | Patrol Games Challenge | Troop Meeting | | | 1:30 PM |
| 1:45 PM | | | | | | Patrol Presentations (Quest for the Meaning of Leadership) | 1:45 PM |
| 2:00 PM | | | Troop Meeting | | "The Hidden Diversity Within Us" Game | | 2:00 PM |
| 2:15 PM | | | | | | | 2:15 PM |
| 2:30 PM | | | | | | Closing Event | 2:30 PM |
| 2:45 PM | | *Transition Time* | | | Resolving Conflicts | | 2:45 PM |
| 3:00 PM | | | | Weekend Closing Assembly | | | 3:00 PM |
| 3:15 PM | | Team Project (Building Pioneering Projects) | | | | | 3:15 PM |
| 3:30 PM | | | Scouting EDGE | | Patrol Games Challenge | | 3:30 PM |
| 3:45 PM | | | | | | | 3:45 PM |
| 4:00 PM | | | | | Patrol Meeting | | 4:00 PM |
| 4:15 PM | | | | | | | 4:15 PM |
| 4:30 PM | | | Patrol Activity | | Outpost Camp Troop Assembly | | 4:30 PM |
| 4:45 PM | | | | | | | 4:45 PM |
| 5:00 PM | | *Transition Time* | | | | | 5:00 PM |
| 5:15 PM | | | | | Outpost Camp | | 5:15 PM |
| 5:30 PM | | Dinner | Dinner | | | | 5:30 PM |
| 5:45 PM | | | | | | | 5:45 PM |
| 6:00 PM | Registration | | | | | | 6:00 PM |
| 6:15 PM | | | | | | | 6:15 PM |
| 6:30 PM | Orientation Trail | "Getting To Know You" Team Games | Model Scouts' Own Worship Service | | | | 6:30 PM |
| 6:45 PM | | | | | | | 6:45 PM |
| 7:00 PM | Campsite Setup | | *Transition Time* | | | | 7:00 PM |
| 7:15 PM | | *Transition Time* | | | | | 7:15 PM |
| 7:30 PM | Opening Troop Assembly | | | | | | 7:30 PM |
| 7:45 PM | | | LEGO® Challenge and Realistic First Aid | | | | 7:45 PM |
| 8:00 PM | Communicating #1 | Movie Night and Reflection | | | | | 8:00 PM |
| 8:15 PM | | | | | | | 8:15 PM |
| 8:30 PM | Finding Your Vision | | *Transition Time* | | | | 8:30 PM |
| 8:45 PM | | | | | | | 8:45 PM |
| 9:00 PM | Expectations for NYLT Staff and Participant Conduct | | Cracker Barrel and Songfest | | | | 9:00 PM |
| 9:15 PM | | | | | | | 9:15 PM |
| 9:30 PM | Model Campfire | | | | | | 9:30 PM |
| 9:45 PM | | | | | | | 9:45 PM |
| 10:00 PM | | Lights Out | Lights Out | | Lights Out | | 10:00 PM |
| 10:15 PM | | | | | | | 10:15 PM |
| 10:30 PM | Lights Out | | | | | | 10:30 PM |


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# Day One: Registration, Orientation Trail, and Campsite Setup

### Time Allowed

3 Hours, 15 Minutes

### Teaching Format

Patrol formation, orientation, and patrol campsite setup will be facilitated by the youth staff members serving as troop guides. The Scoutmasters, assistant youth course leads for program and service, and adult staff will be on hand and may, if appropriate, provide coaching for the troop guides.

All staff members will set a positive tone for the beginning of the course. To the greatest degree possible, staff members should make participants feel that they are welcome, that they belong, and that they are about to begin a worthwhile experience.

Qualified, effective staff members will be familiar with the concepts and content presented throughout the course. At this point, they should recognize that the new patrols are in the *forming* phase of team development. Troop guides and other staff members can model the appropriate leadership style for that phase—***explain***—by being directive and by providing all the information and materials participants require in order to succeed.

### Learning Objectives

As a result of this session, participants will be able to do the following:

1. Form patrols that will stay together throughout the course.
2. Meet the troop guides assigned to their patrols.
3. Locate the troop facilities, meeting places, patrol campsites, and other relevant landmarks.
4. Understand the standards and methods to ensure health and good hygiene, and the emergency response procedures in place during the course.
5. Use the model campsite explanation and demonstration as they set up their own campsites and test them against the Daily Campsite Inspection Checklist.

### Materials Needed

- For each patrol, one blank patrol flag that is attached to a 6-foot pole (These should be 3-by-2-foot squares of cloth that correspond to each patrol's identifying color if colors are used.)
- For each participant, a Participant Notebook (created with resources found in the National NYLT Google Drive and other council resources)
- Copies of the Daily Campsite Inspection Checklist

### Recommended Presenter

NYLT staff

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## Recommended Location

Troop assembly area, model campsite, patrol sites

## PRESENTATION OUTLINE

### Registration

As participants arrive for the beginning of the course, staff members will greet them warmly, ensure that they sign in and have completed all necessary paperwork, and give each participant an NYLT Participant Notebook.

#### *Patrol Formation*

The course adult and youth leadership will determine the membership of each patrol prior to the course. Patrols should reflect sensitivity to the following criteria:

- no coed patrols;
- age similarities;
- range of Scouting skills and rank; and
- geographic, cultural, and program diversity.

Patrols should be made up of youth similar in age to one another so they are divided roughly into patrols of younger youth, older youth, and those in between. Organizing patrols so there is not a large range of ages (ideally no more than two years' difference) can maximize the learning potential and leadership experience of all NYLT participants by giving patrol members equal footing with one another. Maximizing geographic, cultural, and program diversity in each patrol will enhance the ability of each patrol to observe and understand the team dynamics and encourage higher levels of patrol maturity.

As participants complete the registration process and learn to which patrol they will belong, they will move to the patrol gathering area to join their troop guide, who will be holding the patrol flag corresponding to the patrol color. While patrols initially will be identified by color—the red patrol, the blue patrol, etc.—participants may take the initiative later in the course to give their patrols new names.

As an alternative, some courses may choose to have their youth staff name the patrols prior to participants' arrival. Some courses add a theme for each year to add to the fun, and name patrols accordingly.

### Orientation Trail

Along the Orientation Trail, staff members will familiarize participants with their surroundings and explain camp policies. In addition to pointing out other points of interest along the trail, troop guides and patrol members should do the following:

- Identify course facilities, meeting places, living quarters, the quartermaster facilities, and other relevant landmarks.
- Review Youth Protection policies, including no one-on-one contact, guidelines for male-female contact, and the use of the buddy system.

- Review emergency response procedures, explaining the appropriate means for summoning help in case of injury or illness, highlighting fire prevention issues, and discussing any of the area's hazard zones.
- Observe a model campsite. This could be a staff campsite that has been arranged to include a cooking area typical of those the patrols will be using.
- Remind that an appropriate grace should be said before each meal.
- Review safe food handling and storage, as well as guidelines for protecting provisions from animals.

During the Orientation Trail, staff members should emphasize to patrol members the importance of proper hygiene in the bathroom facilities and before any food handling. Staff members can be on hand to demonstrate the soap and water hand-washing stations at latrines and the model patrol campsite and to demonstrate the use and locations of waterless hand cleansers.

***Environmental Concerns***

Staff members should highlight environmental concerns that may affect participants during the course. These might include the following:

- Water: Encourage participants to carry their own water bottles and to drink from them frequently to avoid dehydration.
- Sun protection: Remind participants to use sunscreen, wear hats and protective clothing, and stay in the shade during the hottest part of the day.
- Insect protection: Encourage participants to use insect repellent and wear protective clothing.
- Poisonous plants: Ensure that participants can identify and avoid poison ivy, nettles, and other poisonous plants in the region.

***Duty Rosters***

Staff members will review a sample completed duty roster listing daily assignments, including patrol leader and assistant patrol leader. Participants will have this sample and a blank one that they can complete as a patrol in the Participant Notebook.

***The Patrol Model Campsite***

Before participants arrive, the staff should prepare a model campsite that demonstrates everything expected of the patrol campsites. Staff may use their own campsite, but only if it is basically identical to patrol campsites participants will develop and use.

The model campsite should include a fully equipped dishwashing station to use while ***explaining*** and ***demonstrating*** the group dishwashing system. Sanitation is a top priority in camp.

***Daily Campsite Inspection Checklist***

Staff members should explain that each participant will assess the model campsite using the Daily Campsite Inspection Checklist. People often absorb information better when they have something to do as they are learning, and the checklist encourages their full engagement while examining the campsite. The checklist addresses matters of health, hygiene, and

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safety. It does not include measurements of standards that do not advance the NYLT learning experience (e.g., no emphasis on gateways, elaborate campsite improvements, etc.). The goal is to ensure patrol campsites that are maintained in a clean, healthy, efficient manner.

### *Daily Campsite Inspections*

Staff members will explain that an NYLT staff member will examine each patrol site each day and measure it against the standards on the same Daily Campsite Inspection Checklist the participants used to evaluate the model campsite. In most cases, the inspection will be conducted by the assistant youth course lead for service, who may be accompanied by the troop guide. Ideally, each patrol campsite will begin the course fully compliant with the items on the Daily Campsite Inspection Checklist. The course may choose to provide some type of recognition, which may be something that can easily be attached to the patrol's flag pole.

## Patrol Campsite Setup

As each patrol completes the Orientation Trail and arrives at its campsite, its troop guide will provide the materials and support needed to set up the patrol campsite. The troop guides can be direct in their leadership, offering as much guidance to participants as they need, but also enabling participants to try out skills on their own and figure out solutions—setting up tents and tarps, for example. When troop guides do offer skills instruction, they can draw on the skills of the Scouting EDGE for effective means of conveying the information. Upon the completion of campsite setup, the troop guide will accompany the patrol to the location of the first course assembly.

NATIONAL YOUTH LEADERSHIP TRAINING

## Sample Patrol Duty Roster for __Blue__ Patrol

*Rotation of duties takes place daily at the morning troop assembly. Roster may be adjusted to meet particular patrol needs.*

**Patrol Members**

A. Eric C.
B. Anton M.
C. Zachary T.
D. Rohan S.
E. Oliver P.
F. Tyler J.

| | Assistant Patrol Leader (fire/stoves) | Patrol Leader (water) | Cook 1 | Cook 2 | Cleanup 1 | Cleanup 2 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Day 1 | A | B | C | D | E | F |
| Day 2 | F | A | B | C | D | E |
| Day 3 | E | F | A | B | C | D |
| Day 4 | D | E | F | A | B | C |
| Day 5 | C | D | E | F | A | B |
| Day 6 | B | C | D | E | F | A |

**Patrol Leader**: leads the patrol; attends patrol leaders' council meetings; holds patrol meetings to keep members informed of troop plans and activities; leads the patrol in games, practice, and competitions; sets an example by initiative and Scouting spirit; is responsible for keeping patrol activities on the camp's time/event schedule; maintains the water supply

**Assistant Patrol Leader**: leads the patrol in the patrol leader's absence and assists the patrol leader as requested in the operation of the patrol and participation in activities; maintains supplies of tinder, kindling, and firewood protected from weather; starts fires in time for cooks to have meals ready on time (if applicable)

**Cook 1 and 2**: secure food supplies from the quartermaster at the designated time each day and at such other times as directed; follow menus and recipes exactly after reading directions twice; serve meals on time; put away food; put cooking pots to soak; place cleanup water supply over fire before serving the meal

**Cleanup 1 and 2**: set up wash and rinse water for dishwashing; clean cooking pots, utensils, and patrol's personal eating gear; clean up the kitchen and dining areas; store all patrol equipment; dispose of trash; put out all fires after use

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**Latrine Cleaning Rotation Schedule**

Patrols that are sharing the latrine should get together and work out a schedule so that every patrol takes a turn keeping it clean and in good order.

The latrine should be checked and cleaned twice a day. See that any litter is picked up and disposed of, extra toilet paper is available, the lantern is lit (or the lights are on) at dusk and extinguished in the morning, hand-washing water is available, and that any other chores are accomplished.

| | DAY ONE | DAY TWO | DAY THREE | DAY FOUR | DAY FIVE | DAY SIX |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AM | Red | Yellow | Blue | Orange | Green | Purple |
| PM | Orange | Green | Purple | Red | Yellow | Blue |

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# Daily Campsite Inspection Checklist

*Patrols must receive a score of 90 or above to receive a daily campsite inspection recognition.*

**Patrol Name**: _____ **Date**: _____

| **Tents** | **Possible Points** | **Total** |
|---|---|---|
| Tents neat and properly pitched | 5 | |
| Dining fly neat and properly pitched | 5 | |
| **Tents Total** | **10** | |
| | | |
| **Fire Protection** | | |
| Campfire area properly cleared and secured | 5 | |
| Fire tools present and readily available | 5 | |
| Fire buckets filled and ready | 5 | |
| Stove fuel and firewood properly stored | 5 | |
| **Fire Protection Total** | **20** | |
| | | |
| **Patrol and Personal Equipment** | | |
| Equipment clean and properly stored | 10 | |
| Duty roster filled out and posted | 5 | |
| Personal equipment clean and properly stored | 5 | |
| **Patrol and Personal Equipment Total** | **20** | |
| | | |
| **Health and Safety** | | |
| Campsite free of litter and debris | 5 | |
| First-aid kit in camp and visible | 5 | |
| Handwashing station operational | 10 | |
| Dishwashing practices resulting in clean cooking gear and personal eating utensils | 10 | |
| Cooking equipment neatly stored off the ground | 10 | |
| All food items protected from spoilage, contamination, and animals | 10 | |
| **Health and Safely Total** | **50** | |
| | | |
| **Grand Total** | **100** | |


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# Day One: Opening Troop Assembly

### Time Allowed

30 Minutes

### Teaching Format

The Day One troop assembly serves as participants' formal introduction to the course. They will become acquainted with the troop and will witness the installation of the troop's senior patrol leader. Setting the "tone" of the subsequent assemblies is done here. NYLT staff should choose what kind of assemblies they want to have—fun, loud, formal, solemn, silly—there is no wrong answer; it should just remain consistent throughout the week.

### Learning Objectives

As a result of this session, participants will be able to do the following:

1. Feel welcome and valued (staff, too).
2. Reaffirm that the NYLT course operates according to the Scouting ideals.
3. Participate in the installation ceremony for new patrol leaders and assistant patrol leaders.
4. View youth staff as supporters, guides, and mentors to course participants.
5. Discuss key parts of a good course assembly.
6. Recognize good communication skills.
7. Recognize the spirit and enthusiasm of the course.
8. Be inspired to bring new ideas back to their home units.

### Materials Needed

- American flag
- Course flag
- Historic American flag (British Union Flag)

### Recommended Presenter

Scoutmaster(s) and senior patrol leader(s); all staff should play a part in the assemblies.

### Recommended Location

Troop assembly area

Before a National Youth Leadership Training course begins, staff members should designate the place that will serve as the troop assembly area. It should have flagpoles for displaying an American flag and a troop flag. NYLT staff also may choose to display one historic American flag during each day of the course. In most cases, troop assemblies will take place at an outdoor setting, though indoor areas of sufficient size (e.g., a dining hall) can be adapted to accommodate the activities. Indoors, flags can be presented on staffs with floor stands or can be displayed on a wall. The assembly area should also reflect the spirit and theming of the NYLT course if one is used.

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On Day One, staff will have conducted the flag ceremony before participants arrive, so flags will already be displayed.

## PRESENTATION OUTLINE

### Introduction

In a linked troop course, the course leadership should determine how they will coordinate the elements of the opening assembly and other daily assemblies during staff development. Both Scoutmasters and senior patrol leaders can split the responsibilities or take turns leading the daily assemblies.

The NYLT staff should choose in what spirit the course will enter. NYLT staff may choose a more formal approach or a more spirited one. This is an area for personalization and memorable moments. Allowing the NYLT staff to choose their method of delivery will allow for more personal delivery of all material.

When patrols arrive at the assembly area, troop guides should arrange them in an appropriate formation. All staff members should model effective communication skills whenever addressing the course, including speaking in a clear, confident voice; being aware of body language and position; and making eye contact.

### Scoutmaster's Welcome and Adult Staff Introduction

The Scoutmaster (or Scoutmasters if operating a linked troop) will do the following:

- Use the Scout sign to bring the assembly to order, then address the troop.
- Welcome participants to NYLT and express their pleasure in having everyone there.
- Introduce themself as the Scoutmaster of this (or a specific troop if operating a linked troop) NYLT troop.
- Introduce the adult staff members of this (or a specific troop if operating a linked troop) NYLT troop.

### Scoutmaster's Vision

***Note:*** *The following is one example. You do not have to use it as written. You should know the material so that you do not have to read it. This could also be adapted to a shared vision delivered by both Scoutmasters if operating a linked troop.*

"I want to share with you my vision for this course. A vision is a picture of what future success looks like. If we can see it, we can be it.

My vision is that our course will be a model of how every Scouts BSA troop can succeed. In the best tradition of Scouting, this will be a youth-run course. My vision of what success looks like has three parts.

First, as Scoutmaster I see myself fulfilling my responsibility for the safety of everyone and the general direction of the troop's program. I see the course operating according to the Scout Oath and the Scout Law and following the guidance of the National Council. Scouting has no room for hazing, bullying, or other inappropriate behavior. We are all here to help

one another have the best possible experience. Our principles can guide us in that direction throughout the course.

Second, I see the adult leaders giving responsibility for leading the course to the senior patrol leader and the course's other youth leaders. We will always be available to coach and mentor them, but as much as possible, I see us staying on the sidelines while the senior patrol leader and other youth leaders plan and carry out a great program. We will not hide that coaching and mentoring. In fact, now and then we will ask you to watch us doing it so you will know how it can work in your home units.

Third, my vision of success includes everyone on the staff, both youth and adult, seeing themselves here to help each of you learn as much as you can and enjoy the fellowship of other Scouts. We are here for you. I see us doing all we can to make it possible for you to get the most out of the NYLT experience."

**Introduction and Installation of Senior Patrol Leader(s)**

The Scoutmaster (or Scoutmasters if operating a linked troop) introduces the senior patrol leader(s) and conducts the installation by doing the following:

- Invite the senior patrol leader(s) to come forward to be installed.
- Provide a brief introduction of the senior patrol leader(s).
- Ask the senior patrol leader(s) to gather around the troop flagpole, placing their left hands on the pole.
- Instruct them to give the Scout sign and repeat, "I promise to do my best / to be worthy of this office of senior patrol leader / for the sake of my fellow Scouts and my troop."
- Welcome them as the course's new senior patrol leader(s).
- Turn the meeting over to the senior patrol leader(s). The course leadership will determine how the remainder of this activity will operate if utilizing the linked troop model.

**Installation of Patrol Leaders and Assistant Patrol Leaders**

The sample patrol duty roster included in the Participant Notebook indicates which patrol members will serve as patrol leader and assistant patrol leader each day of the course. Before the troop assembly begins, troop guides should point out this information to the Day One patrol leaders and assistant patrol leaders so they will be ready to be installed and to begin providing leadership to their patrols. If operating a linked troop, this may be done together or separately.

> ***Note:*** As with the entrance to the troop assembly, the "flavor" of the course is to be dictated by the senior patrol leader(s) and their staff. Installations don't always need to be serious and solemn, as long as they stay consistent for all involved. Ideas for fun installations can include reciting fun and personal sayings, walking backwards around the flagpole, sitting together on the ground, or anything else that may contribute to a fun and memorable experience. Whatever may be chosen, be sure that the staff that conducts the installation does the action or recites the words with the patrol leaders and assistant patrol leaders—that is what unites them in the bond together.

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The senior patrol leader begins the installation. They should do the following:

- Welcome members of the NYLT course.
- Invite the new patrol leaders and assistant patrol leaders to come forward to be installed.
- Ask the new patrol leaders to gather around the course flagpole, placing their left hands on the pole. New assistant patrol leaders stand behind their patrol leaders, each placing a left hand on the patrol leader's right shoulder.
- Instruct them all to give the Scout sign and repeat a chosen oath which includes, "I promise to do my best to be worthy of this office for the sake of my fellow Scouts in my patrol and for others in this troop."
- Welcome them as the troop's new patrol leaders and assistant patrol leaders.

**Youth Staff Introductions**

The senior patrol leader explains to the troop that communicating well is a key skill of leadership. Throughout the course, staff members will be modeling effective means of communicating. As they communicate, staff members and participants should make a point to use the following communication skills:

- Good, clear voice projection
- Body language, including positioning
- Eye contact with the audience
- A firm, confident handshake

The senior patrol leader asks each staff member to step forward and, with good communication skills, introduces them to the troop, tells where each is from, and describes the staff role each has accepted for the course. This is another great moment for personalization from the staff. For example, maybe the quartermaster team has chef's hats, or the troop guides all have walking sticks that they raise up in the air as they introduce themselves. Modeling pride in job duty as well as the sense of teamwork and bond that a particular group may have is a great way to inspire leadership within the course and model a high performing team.

When appropriate, the senior patrol leader can provide encouragement and guidance, pointing out communication skills a staff member is using well, suggesting another approach a staff member might try to improve their introduction, etc. The idea is to offer the best possible communication models and to model a safe, comfortable learning environment in which suggestions for improvement can be offered, accepted, and experienced by staff and participants alike.

**Announcements**

Announcements are a key component of any troop assembly. At this time, any staff member that has something to tell the group can do this here. The senior patrol leader can also go over the next agenda item of the day. By introducing the idea of announcements, participants can see the value in the troop assembly for the dissemination of information.

## Widgets

Another fun piece of the troop assembly can be the introduction of a "widget". A widget is a fun, silly, or memorable announcement or character that is introduced for the duration of the NYLT week.

Ideas for widgets that can be stand-alone ideas or recurring, daily events include (but are not limited to) the following:

- Word of the day: a word that is introduced at the assembly that, when heard throughout the day, can evoke a cheer or action or laugh.
- Unextreme extreme sports: a very silly "contest" between 2–4 staff members that is fun to repeat throughout the week.
    - Ideas include: extreme grass growing (staff sit and cheer on grass growing), extreme napping (bring blanket and sleep), and extreme jump roping (some staff throw a rope to make it jump, while others actually jump rope).
    - The point of this announcement is to be creative and silly, give the participants someone to root for and cheer on, and just to let off some steam. Characters for this include your sports participants, a referee, and a judge. This also gives the participants a chance to see staff that they don't always interact with up in front of the group.
- Funny exercise leaders: maybe a couple of expressive and loud staff members that lead the group in a silly daily exercise.
    - Ideas include: push-ups where they lay on their backs and push their arms up in the sky (push UP), loud breathing, jump backs (jump a step backward), and so on.
    - The exercise is silly but gives the whole group something to do together and get moving!
- Weather report: a Scouting classic!
- Prayer: demonstrating that a Scout is reverent!
- Daily meditative moment: an abstract saying that gets the group thinking. When done seriously, it can be very thought provoking!

Allowing the staff to brainstorm and come up with these funny moments during staff development, and then choose those who will carry them out, can really enliven your troop assemblies and start out each day with laughter and a sense of community. This is one of those intangible parts of team building that is very important to NYLT development.

Once the business and fun of the troop assembly is done, the senior patrol leader then invites the Scoutmaster to share a few comments and a Scoutmaster's Minute with the troop.

## Scoutmaster Comments

The Scoutmaster(s) thanks the senior patrol leader(s) and congratulates the new patrol leaders and assistant patrol leaders. The Scoutmaster(s) asks if the participants have noticed that until now, the senior patrol leader(s) have been leading the assembly just as the senior patrol leader of a troop, president of a crew, or a boatswain of a ship would.

That is the way it should be in a troop, crew, or ship, with youth leaders taking charge and the unit's adult leaders staying in the background to coach and mentor.

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The Scoutmaster(s) explains that Scouting America encourages the youth-led, adult-guided unit. Youth are given all the information and resources they need to run the unit themselves. Adult leaders are there to provide support, coaching, and mentoring. The NYLT course will run that way as well. Adult leaders will be supportive and are always available to provide guidance whenever youth staff or patrol members need it. Most of the time, though, adult team leaders will be on the sidelines, allowing the youth leaders of the staff to carry out their duties and make things happen.

**Scoutmaster's Minute**

"You can help individuals wherever you are, no matter how small your action is. Take this moment as an example: There was a person walking along an ocean beach one hot summer day. As they walked, they saw in the distance another person who appeared to be doing a strange dance, bending over again and again. As the first person got closer, they saw that the person was picking up starfish that had washed up on the shore and throwing them back into the ocean. The first person asked, 'Why are you throwing those starfish into the sea?' The person then replied, 'The tide is going out, the sun is hot, and if I don't, they will die here.'

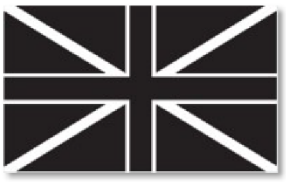
The first person then asked why they were doing this since the beach was miles long and there were thousands of starfish; the few they threw back wouldn't make any difference. The person paused with a starfish in their hand. They looked at it, then looked out at the ocean. As they tossed the starfish out, they said with a smile, 'Made a difference to that one.' As you journey through this week of NYLT, ask yourself this question: How can I make a difference with my small contribution to the greater whole, and how can life be changed by my actions?"

**Closing**

The senior patrol leader(s) thanks the Scoutmaster(s), asks the troop to join them in the Scout Oath and Law, and then brings the assembly to a close by directing the troop guides to accompany their patrols to the site of the next activity.

NATIONAL YOUTH LEADERSHIP TRAINING

# Historic American Flag Presentation: British Union Flag



**British Union Flag**

The British Union flag, sometimes called the Union Jack, was carried by the Jamestown settlers in 1607 and by the pilgrims who arrived on the Mayflower in 1620. Today, it is the official flag of the United Kingdom. Its design can be found in the Hawaii state flag and several flags of other nations, including New Zealand and Australia.

Of special note is the fact that the British Union flag was flown upside down—usually a sign of distress—many times when forces were under siege during the Boer War. Scouts will remember one hero of the Boer War: Robert S. S. Baden Powell, the founder of the worldwide Scouting movement.

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# Day One: Communicating—Part 1: The Model

### Time Allowed

30 Minutes

### Teaching Format

Troop presentation with patrol activity

### Learning Objectives

As a result of this session, participants will be able to do the following:

1. Understand Aristotle's Model of Communication.
2. State the parts of Aristotle's Model of Communication.
3. Use Aristotle's Model of Communication.

### Materials Needed

- Visual aid(s) developed by presenter
- Computer
- LCD projector and screen
- Appropriate sound system for presentation venue
- Flip chart and markers for each patrol
- 1 small ball (e.g., tennis ball) for each patrol

### Recommended Presenter

NYLT staff member

### Recommended Location

Troop assembly area

## PRESENTATION OUTLINE

***Note:*** Guide participants to locate the Participant Notes sheet for this session in the Participant Notebook. Encourage them to be taking note of key words, key points, and their top three takeaways from the session.

### The Role of Communication in Leadership (8 min)

Communication is such an important part of developing participants' leadership skills that there will be a Communicating session on each day of the course.

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Ask participants, “What does leadership mean to you?” Encourage answers from different patrols in the troop. Don’t discourage any answers. To encourage reflection, if a participant gives a joking or a vague answer, ask them to expand. Sometimes humorous answers can be the source of deeper insight. *There is no need to record participants’ answers on a whiteboard or flip chart*.

> ***Note:*** This question is intended to provoke reflection. The staff may decide to collectively reflect on what “leadership” means to them, and they could share their meaning with the course participants. There are many possible definitions of “leadership.” For example, leadership can mean having an effective combination of traits and skills that enable a group of people to resolve a problem and/or move forward in a desired direction.

Once you have half a dozen answers to “What does leadership mean to you?”, ask participants, “What does *good* leadership mean to you?”

> ***Note:*** This question is also intended to provoke reflection and there is no “right” or single answer. It is difficult to envision how an individual would be considered an effective leader without the individual demonstrating the ability to communicate effectively with those around them. Every situation is unique, and there isn’t a singular style or approach that guarantees effective communication. As with the first question, the staff may decide to formulate an answer that they share with participants.

Explain that leadership includes many qualities and dimensions; an objective of a leader is to influence others to take action or to move in the direction that the leader and the team want to go.

In order to have influence, leaders need to have good communication skills.

Share the following with participants: During NYLT, you will learn about the different parts of communication so that you can increase your awareness of your own communication skills/styles and make adjustments to improve your influence. All presentations during the NYLT course will follow Aristotle’s Model of Communication.

**Aristotle’s Model of Communication (8 min)**

Message—Sender—Receiver

All forms of communication can be broken into these three components. Forms of communication can include: an individual 1:1 conversation, a presentation to a group, an email, a text, a social media post, a picture, a painting, a song, a photograph, a movie, etc. There’s a message in every form of communication. We want to think about how to convey the message as effectively as possible.

The presenter should casually throw an object (such as a tennis ball) to another staff member, who will catch it. State that Aristotle’s Model of Communication was just used. Can anyone explain why? Entertain answers and share that the ball represented a message: “I threw the ball, so I was the sender, and the person who caught it was the receiver.”

The presenter should throw the same object to the same individual, but the receiver should either not catch or drop the ball. Ask the participants what just happened? Entertain answers and share that this was not effective communication because the message never made it to the receiver.

This model was developed by Aristotle, a famous philosopher who died more than 2,000 years ago. His communication model is still relevant today because it's logical and simple. When communicating, a leader is both a sender and a receiver because communication requires both speaking and listening. The sender needs to ensure that the message they are sending is received and understood.

**Communication Skills Practice (12 min)**

***Note:*** The troop guides help break the troop into patrols for this exercise.

The troop guide explains that participants will take turns practicing effective communication skills by making a short presentation to the patrol. The content of the presentation is not important for this exercise—in fact, it will be simply reciting the alphabet. What matters is using as many communication skills as possible.

Troop guides begin the exercise by standing in front of the group and, demonstrating effective communication skills, reciting the alphabet. Next, they ask several patrol members to stand in front of the group and repeat the exercise, concentrating on using effective communication skills.

> ***Note to Troop Guides/Patrol Presenters:*** You should be using the neutral position in what you do without referencing it to participants. Asking participants to recite the alphabet provides content everyone knows without thinking, which allows presenters and observers to concentrate on their communication skills.

As each participant finishes their presentation of the alphabet, the troop guide can lead a short debriefing of that person's use of communication skills. First, ask the participant to explain how they use their feet, hands, mouth, eyes, and ears. Encourage the participant to say at least one positive thing about their method. Next, ask patrol members to provide good feedback on the person's use of communication skills. The troop guide should provide positive comments and offer suggestions for improvement.

After several patrol members have made the alphabet presentation and practiced their communication skills, invite several other participants to stand in front of the troop, count out loud to 10, then introduce a member of the patrol to the rest of the troop. Their challenge is to use good communication skills throughout.

**Summary/Conclusion (2 min)**

This session was intended to convey the importance of communication to developing leadership skills and to introduce Aristotle's MaSeR model of communication that provides the theme/outline for the remaining Communicating sessions. If participants remember nothing else about communicating, we want them to remember that all communication pieces include ***messages*** and that they have responsibilities as ***senders*** and ***receivers*** of

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***messages***. Conclude by saying, “Our aim this week is for you to be an effective communicator, so you don’t drop the ball.”

> ***Note:*** Consider holding up the ball and physically dropping it as you say the last phrase.

Remind participants to take a moment to ensure they have noted their top three takeaways in their Participant Notes for this session.

# Day One: Finding Your Vision

### Time Allowed

30 Minutes

### Teaching Format

Troop presentation

### Learning Objectives

As a result of this session, participants will be able to do the following:

1. Define vision as what future success looks like
2. Understand the difference between a team vision and personal visions
3. Understand the evolution of a vision
4. Explain that failure is okay as they achieve their vision
5. Begin thinking about the personal vision that they will develop by the end of the course

### Materials Needed

- Visual aid(s) developed by presenter
- Video clip(s) available on the National NYLT Google Drive
- Computer
- LCD projector and screen
- Appropriate sound system for presentation venue

### Recommended Presenter

NYLT staff member

### Recommended Location

Troop assembly area

## PRESENTATION OUTLINE

***Note:*** Guide participants to locate the Participant Notes sheet for this session in the Participant Notebook. Encourage them to be taking note of key words, key points, and their top three takeaways from the session.

### Opening Activity (7 min)

Using either posters prepared ahead of time or a PowerPoint slide, show each of the following visions individually and ask participants if they can identify the company it belongs to:

- “A computer on every desk and in every home.” (Microsoft)
- “To become the world’s most loved, most flown, and most profitable airline.” (Southwest)

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- “Bring inspiration and innovation to every athlete in the world.” (Nike)
- “To be the world leader in transportation products and related services.” (General Motors)

Ask participants what all these statements have in common.

None of these statements are saying they are going to sell more shoes, cars, or computers. Rather, they define what future success looks like. Selling products or services may be one way they achieve their vision, but it is not their goal. Profit, for successful businesses, is a result rather than the goal. This is becoming clearer today as we see innovation within companies.

Ask participants what other companies they can think of that have reinvented themselves to survive and succeed during changing times.

- Amazon: originally an online bookstore; now it sells everything
- Netflix: began mailing DVDs to customers; now streams videos
- Apple: moved beyond computers to streaming music; iTunes is the biggest part of Apple
- Scouting America: included girls in all of its programs

Ask participants what other companies or industries they can think of that did not reinvent themselves and are no longer here or almost non-existent.

- Blockbuster Video: video/DVD rental store replaced by Netflix and other streaming services
- Atari: video game company replaced by Nintendo, Xbox, and PlayStation
- Kodak: film and camera company replaced by digital cameras and smartphone cameras

**What is a Vision? (7 min)**

Ask if anyone can tell you what a vision is.

Explain that a vision is what future success looks like. The best vision is built on your “why.” Why is it important to you? The “why” is really important because as a leader, people need to understand why something needs to be done. Why do I need to go get firewood? Why do I need to clean the dishes? In terms of a vision, why is my vision for success important to me? Why do I want to be that?

Share that one of the most important ideas leaders can communicate is where they want the team to go. It is hard to lead if you do not have a destination in mind. Take this course, for example.

Note that they are at the beginning of their NYLT journey. Ask them, “When we reach the last day of this course, what will success look like to you?” Be sure to explain the why.

> ***Note***: If participants are unclear on the question, you may want to rephrase the question as, “When you signed up for NYLT, what were you expecting to get out of the week?”

Entertain answers. Invite participants to turn to another participant and answer this question. Invite them to share the answers with the group.

Participants might see themselves as better leaders or as having more skills. They may imagine themselves with new friendships, or with fresh ideas to take back to their home units. It is important to note that completing the course would merely be a goal. Completing the course could, however, be one of the goals toward becoming a quality troop leader.

Each participant's answer is a vision. The word vision comes from the word visual . . . to see. In a vision, you can see yourself doing something, being something.

**Vision is what future success looks like.**

To put it another way:

**If you can see it, you can be it.**

Encourage participants to dream big. Dream about what is possible. Share the vision. Think of a vision as not something you want to do or could do, but something you clearly see in your future and will commit to.

As American poet Carl Sandburg wrote, "Nothing happens unless first a dream." An important part of developing a vision is being able to describe it. The dream comes first, followed by the words. Words can paint a picture of the future and help turn a dream into a vision that can be communicated. When a dream can be shared, the picture of future success is real.

**Transition to Creating a Team Vision (4 min)**

**Show**: "1_04_Finding Your Vision_Video Clip 1.mp4" from the movie *Jobs*.

Ask participants what they saw in the clip.

Often, individuals don't understand what is in front of them and how it can change the world. If Steve Wozniak never shared with Steve Jobs a personal computer he built, would the Apple computer be around?

It is critical we communicate with others our projects, goals, and vision. Involving others in creating a vision doesn't just allow you to think outside the box; it can also help motivate a team, as they now have personal ownership with that shared vision. This is the true essence of a shared vision.

**The Shared Vision of a Team (8 min)**

Explain that a team vision is a picture of what future success looks like for a group of people who are a team. If all the team members can picture themselves succeeding, they can work together to put themselves into that picture. If they can see it, they can be it.

Several months ago, this staff came together to put together a world-class leadership training program for Scouts in our area. We set goals, had staff meetings, practiced presentations, and ultimately arrived here at this facility to greet our participants. We had a

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shared vision. It is our goal that we help you achieve your vision or at least set you on a path to achieve your vision by the end of this week.

Likewise, we can see team visions in our personal lives. Invite participants to share some ideas with others in their patrol. Ask for a few participants to share with the group. These ideas may include a sports team achieving a championship, a band performing a complicated musical piece, or a unit doing a challenging backpacking trek.

Have a staff member share the staff vision they developed during staff development.

Explain that the members of the patrol are going to create a team vision. To do this, they will do the following:

- Brainstorm about what they will achieve as a patrol during the week.
- Bring together all their ideas to form a vision of patrol success.
- Communicate their vision to others.

Since this is the first time the participants are creating a vision, have them complete the following sentence: “On the last day of this NYLT course, we see ourselves (or we will) _____.”

Have each troop guide sit with their patrol and ask the following questions to help the patrol shape its vision:

- At the end of this course, what will be a measure of success for our patrol?
- How will you know you have achieved what you are setting out to do?
- What actions do you think you need to take along the way to make that happen?
- Why is it going to be important for you to do this?

Once all patrols have developed a vision, invite each patrol to share with the troop.

**Evaluation of a Vision (2 min)**

Share that as individuals, we all will have multiple personal visions and team visions. It is critical we are always taking a moment to reflect on how what we think future success looks like may have changed. A simple yet relevant example might be choosing your career. Today, you may have a vision on becoming a high school teacher because you love math. Your goals are that you begin to take advanced math classes in high school, participate in STEM summer camps, and complete the Engineering merit badge.

You finally graduate high school and begin to take college courses. Upon doing so, you realize you have a passion for math and re-evaluate your vision by expanding it to include becoming an advanced math college professor.

You course corrected. Life is about course corrections, and they can be in a variety of directions. When you make a course correction, it is important that you reset your vision and create new goals to accomplish your vision.

**Conclusion (2 min)**

Summarize by sharing that in life, we will set visions for ourselves and the teams we lead. Today at NYLT, you have all set your patrol visions for what you will be and what you will achieve by the end of the course. You have heard our vision for each of you on your NYLT Leadership Journey.

Later this week, we will be creating personal visions. As we go through the next few days, keep the vision your patrol has developed in the back of your mind.

Invite participants to ask any questions.

Remind participants to take a moment to ensure they have noted their top three takeaways in their Participant Notes for this session.

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# Day One: Expectations for NYLT Staff and Participant Conduct

### Time Allowed

30 Minutes

### Teaching Format

Patrol activity in the patrol setting

### Learning Objectives

As a result of this session, participants will be able to do the following:

1. Recognize the code of conduct for the course.
2. Agree to follow the code of conduct for the course.

### Materials Needed

- Course Code of Conduct Acknowledgment Form

### Recommended Presenter

Troop guides

### Recommended Location

Patrol breakout area

## PRESENTATION OUTLINE

### Setting Expectations for Personal Behavior During the Course (30 min)

Each troop guide facilitates the patrol discussing, in detail, the code of conduct for personal behavior during the course.

During this course, between 30 and 48 youth will be coming together for six days in an intensive group learning experience. They will be camping together, preparing meals together, eating together, playing together, role-playing together, and learning together. Understanding the code of conduct together is a team-building exercise in itself. Members of a patrol that discusses and signs the required rules together are more likely to take ownership of them and conduct themselves according to this code. They are more likely to use peer pressure to bring a participant's behavior that is at variance with the code back into conformity.

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Each patrol should begin by discussing the following points:

1. Everyone has the right to live and study in an environment free from discrimination or harassment based on race, color, ethnicity, religion, gender, sexual orientation, age, disability, national origin, or citizenship.
2. It is my responsibility not to engage in behaviors that constitute discrimination or harassment.
3. It is my responsibility to report instances of discrimination or harassment (directed at me or another participant) to my NYLT Course Director, or any adult on the NYLT course.

Comments and conduct that might be perceived as offensive include the following:

1. Using vulgar language.
2. Threatening another participant or staff member or making derogatory comments.
3. Mocking or telling jokes based on race, color, ethnicity, religion, gender, sexual orientation, age, disability, national origin, or citizenship.
4. Displaying degrading photographs, posters, or objects.
5. Reading out loud about degrading acts.
6. Touching (e.g., brushing, patting, hugging, rubbing, pinching) other staff members or participants.
7. Staring or leering at participants or staff members.

Note that courses are permitted to establish additional conduct points beyond what is in the previous list.

The code of conduct should be signed by everyone, including the troop guides and other staff members, and given to the NYLT Course Director. It should also be posted in a common area where it will be seen regularly by everyone as well as included in everyone's Participant Notebook.

NATIONAL YOUTH LEADERSHIP TRAINING

# Acknowledgment of Course Code of Conduct Free from Discrimination and Harassment

I understand that:

1. Everyone has the right to live and study in an environment free from discrimination or harassment based on race, color, ethnicity, religion, gender, sexual orientation, age, disability, national origin, or citizenship.
2. It is my responsibility not to engage in behaviors that constitute discrimination or harassment.
3. It is my responsibility to report instances of discrimination or harassment (directed at me or another participant) to my NYLT Course Director or any adult on my NYLT course.

Comments and conduct that might be perceived as offensive include:

1. Using vulgar language.
2. Threatening another participant or staff member or making derogatory comments.
3. Mocking or telling jokes based on race, color, ethnicity, religion, gender, sexual orientation, age, disability, national origin, or citizenship.
4. Displaying degrading photographs, posters or objects.
5. Reading out loud about degrading acts.
6. Touching (e.g., brushing, patting, hugging, rubbing, pinching) other staff members or participants.
7. Staring or leering at participants or staff members.

I acknowledge that I have read and understand this statement.

_____ _____

Print Name Signature

# Day One: "Getting to Know You" Team Games

**Time Allowed**

60 Minutes

**Teaching Format**

Patrol activity in the troop setting

**Learning Objectives**

"Getting to know you" games are a tool for building trust and understanding. They are especially effective for enabling communication and strengthening relationships among patrol members. By playing the games in this order, participants will be able to do the following:

1. Increase the common ground they share with fellow patrol members.
2. Highlight some of the diversity existing among members of the patrol.
3. Develop a greater sense of trust with others in the group.
4. Better understand their own beliefs.

**Materials Needed**

- Wood Badge thumball for Ball Toss game or a DIY version made from a rubber playground ball (see instructional document available in the National NYLT Google Drive) *(one per patrol)*
- Questions for Ball Toss game *(one per patrol; questions appear below)*

**Recommended Presenter**

Troop guides

**Recommended Location**

Patrol breakout area

## PRESENTATION OUTLINE

The troop guides facilitate the games below, ensuring that all patrol members feel comfortable in participating fully.

### 1. Zip, Zap, Zop (12 min)

Zip, Zap, Zop is about focus and energy. As patrol members pass the energy across a large circle (in the form of a Zip, a Zap, or a Zop), they make eye contact with the person they send the energy to and work together to keep the rhythm going. This activity serves as an introduction for patrol members to make eye contact with each other and as a fun icebreaker before diving deeper into getting to know each other.

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***Directions**:*

Invite patrol members to stand in a circle. Ask the group to repeat the words “Zip, Zap, Zop” three or four times, all together.

The troop guide introduces the activity:

“Imagine that I have a bolt of energy in my hands. To start the game, I will send the bolt of energy out of my body with a strong forward motion straight to someone else in the circle *(use hands, body, eyes, and voice to make contact across the circle)* and say, “Zip.” Explain that the next person takes the energy and passes it immediately to someone else saying “Zap.” That person passes it on to another participant with a “Zop.” The game continues and the “Zip, Zap, Zop” sequence is repeated as the energy moves around the circle.

Encourage all patrol members to use their whole body to send energy and to make eye contact. They can send the energy to whomever they want, but the goal is to include all players. Practice the game. If there is a mistake, encourage the patrol to simply resume playing without discussion. The group challenge is to go very quickly and stay consistent in rhythm; if the patrol struggles, pause the game, discuss strategy, and try again.

**2. Signs (12 min)**

Signs is a simple game designed to get people paying attention to each other and focusing on other members in the circle. Patrol members stand in a circle and “pass” a sign—such as a hand motion, gesture, or movement—to each other, without interruption.

***Directions**:*

Invite patrol members to stand in a large circle, facing inward toward each other. Every patrol member chooses a “sign”—some kind of hand motion, gesture, or movement that is unique to them. A sign must be easily detectable by others. Good examples of possible signs could include:

- squeezing your nose,
- patting the top of your head twice,
- making moose ears,
- making two thumbs up, or
- hopping on one foot.

Once everyone has created a sign, each participant announces and demonstrates their sign to the rest of the group. You’re now ready to play the game.

The goal of Signs is to keep passing signs to other players as long as possible, without stopping the action. The troop guide chooses one person in the circle (randomly) to be the person who begins with their sign. Player 1 (who starts with the sign) now “has” the sign, and their goal is to “pass” the sign on to any other player. To pass the sign, Player 1 must perform their own sign and then any other player’s sign.

For example, if Player 1’s sign is to make two thumbs up, and if Player 3’s sign is to pat the top of their head, Player 1 must make two thumbs up and then pat the top of their head in order to “pass” the sign onto Player 3. Player 1 is now at rest, and Player 3 has the sign.

Player 3 now must do their own symbol and then someone else's symbol in order to continue "passing" the sign.

The process continues until someone loses the "sign" and forgets to do the action. There is no "loser" in this game, just lots of laughter!

**3. Concentration (12 min)**

Before the game begins, have each patrol members think about a category of their choosing (e.g., fruits, brand names, sports, music genres, or even destinations across the world). Patrol members then place their hands out to their sides, palms facing up, with each patrol member's left hand under the right hand of the person next to them.

**Rules**:

1. Patrol members cannot repeat items that already have been said in this round of the game or say any item that does not fit within the chosen category.
2. Patrol members must respond within the given time and cannot pause too long to think about a response.

The first to violate a rule will be "out."

***Directions**:*

Invite patrol members to stand in a large circle. Once the circle is formed, the patrol starts the chant below. On each word, they "pass" to the next person by taking their right hand and clapping the upturned hand of the person on their left. At the final word of the chant, that person picks the category and each patrol member must provide an answer to it as they clap the hands of the person on the left without "dropping" the category. This is the chant:

> This – is – a – game – of – concentration, – with – no – repeats – or – hesitation. – Category – is – _____ *(choose a category that you want to play with)*!

Each person then goes around the circle saying something that pertains to that category (i.e., If the category is pets, participants will list dog, cat, pony, bird, and so on). Play continues until a player either repeats a word or can't say a new word; then that player is "out."

This game requires participants to concentrate on the game and really focus on and remember what they and other participants have said. It provides insight into what categories patrol members choose and gives each patrol member a chance to see something that they may have in common with another participant. It also helps to break down physical barriers by getting patrol members comfortable with clapping the hand of the person next to them. (***Note***: Alterations for social distancing can include participants clapping their own hands while looking to their left on each word to pass the category around the circle.)

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## 4. Ball Toss (12 min)

This activity is intended to provide time for patrol members to quickly share information about themselves, including personal beliefs, values, and experiences. It is not a forum for divulging confidential or sensitive information, nor is the discussion intended to become controversial or divisive. Patrol members need to feel confident that the information they share will be respected by other members in the group.

Troop guides take responsibility for setting boundaries, clarifying procedures, and moving the conversation forward when necessary.




***Directions**:*

Patrol members stand or sit in a circle. The Wood Badge thumball *(pictured to the right)* or a DIY equivalent (instructions are available in the National NYLT Google Drive) is tossed to a patrol member. The number of the question to be answered is underneath or closest to the catcher's thumb. Question choices corresponding to each number are printed on a list *(below)* the troop guide can reference and read aloud. After the catcher answers a question, they toss the ball to another participant.

Proceed at a pace that gives all patrol members a chance to answer a question or two in each round. Play at least two rounds using the "Getting to Know You" questions below. If there's time for another round, consider variations to answering such as the following:

- Ask another patrol member to answer the same question.
- Predict how you think another patrol member would respond to the question.

***"Getting to Know You" Questions***

**Side One**

- What is your given name, and why did your parents name you that?
- If you were to describe yourself as a cartoon character, which would you be and why?
- Describe the first place in which you remember living.
- What is one of your favorite possessions and why?
- What is the most important thing you have learned in Scouting?

**Side Two**

- What is the one type of food you dislike and why?
- Describe something you like about where you live.
- If you could be an expert in any field, what would it be?
- Who is the greatest leader in world history? Why did you choose that person?
- Tell us about one of your favorite childhood memories.

**Side Three**

- What is your idea of a great vacation?
- What type(s) of music do you listen to?
- Who is the person you most respect in Scouting? Why?
- What is something you have done in your life that makes you proud?
- Describe the impact Scouting has had on your life thus far.

**Side Four**

- Name the best movie you've ever seen.
- Do you have any pets? Why or why not? If so, what kind and how many?
- Name the best sporting or entertainment event you have ever seen in person.
- What person do you admire the most today?
- Describe yourself in one word.

**Side Five**

- What is your favorite color, and what does it make you think of?
- Who is your favorite celebrity? Why?
- Tell us about your best friend and what qualities you look for in a friend.
- What three items would you want with you on a deserted island?
- Describe an event in your life that helped you become the person you are today.

**Side Six**

- What is your favorite holiday or celebration? Why?
- What is your favorite TV show? Why?
- If you could live somewhere else in the country or world, where would it be?
- What do people like best about you?
- What is something that makes you happy?

**Side Seven**

- Name a song that makes you happy.
- Who is one of your heroes, and how has that person influenced your life?
- Have you held or currently have a job? Why or why not?
- Who is your mentor? Tell us about them?
- What do you like about your Scout unit?

**Side Eight**

- If you were king or queen for a day, what would you do?
- If you had a week left to live, what would you do?
- What is the most important thing you have learned in Scouting?
- If you could change one thing about yourself, what would it be?
- Is your glass half full or half empty?

**Side Nine**

- What are two words you would use to describe your generation?
- How did you get involved in Scouting?
- What is the most important thing you have learned about life?
- What do you think is the most important issue facing our country today?
- What is the most embarrassing thing you ever did?

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**Side Ten**

- Describe the characteristics of the best Scout you know.
- What's your favorite holiday?
- Tell us about one of your strengths.
- If you could go back in time to change one thing, what would it be?
- Name three milestones thus far in your life.

**Side Eleven**

- What is your favorite activity outside of school? Why?
- What motivates you to work hard?
- What makes you laugh the most?
- If you could only eat one meal for the rest of your life, what would it be?
- Do you like or dislike surprises? Why or why not?

**Side Twelve**

- Who was your favorite coach or teacher? Why?
- What do you plan to accomplish in the next 10 years?
- If money were no object, what would you do all day?
- What is the best gift you have been given?
- What would you do if you won the lottery?

**5. Questions (12 min)**

Questions is a simple but lively game designed to get the patrol to ask questions of each other in a more relaxed fashion. This game should be the last one played, as it will inevitably lead to natural conversation to help discover common ground and differences in patrol members.

***Directions****:*

Patrol members sit in a circle and, one at a time, ask a question of the person sitting on their left. The person receiving the question then asks a new question of the person on their left. The goal is not to answer the question, not to laugh or react, but to ask a new question of the person on their left without breaking rhythm. If they can't, then the game stops and everyone takes a pause to answer the question that "got" the person to stop the flow. It's a great way for youth to find out more about each other in a very relaxed manner. Troop guides help facilitate the answer part of the game, but keep the activity light. It's fun to see who the best "question asker" is—the one that gets everyone's attention the most!

Good questions to get to know someone better include the following:

- If your life were a movie, what would it be called?
- What's the last concert you went to?
- What do you wish you were really good at?
- If you were a dog, what kind of dog would you be?
- Do you believe in aliens?
- What's the most cringeworthy outfit you've ever worn?
- If you could be any animal, what would you be?
- Would you rather leave your hometown and never be able to return again, or stay in your hometown but never be able to leave?

- If you had to rename yourself, what name would you choose?
- What was the last show you binge-watched?
- If you had a time machine, would you go back in time or visit the future?
- If you could only hear one song for the rest of your life, what would it be?
- If any actor or actress could play you in a movie, who would it be?

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# Day One: Model Campfire

### Time Allowed

60 Minutes

### Teaching Format

Troop presentation

A youth staff member who is skilled in leading campfires assumes the dual roles of session instructor and master of ceremonies.

The instructional presentation at the beginning of the campfire provides guidelines for effective campfire programs. The instructor then becomes a master of ceremonies, introducing staff members whose songs, skits, ceremonies, and other offerings illustrate important concepts of appropriate campfire programs.

As with any good campfire, the staff members who will be involved should make their plans well in advance of the program. The session instructor/master of ceremonies should already know what will be included in the instructional portion of the program. Staff members can then settle on the songs, skits, stories, and other offerings they will present to support key portions of the instructional message.

### Learning Objectives

As a result of this session, participants will be able to do the following:

1. Experience a model for running a successful campfire.
2. Explore ways to present an appropriate, enjoyable campfire.
3. Practice effective communication skills.
4. Receive the Scoutmaster's challenge for each patrol to develop its Quest for the Meaning of Leadership.
5. Observe an exemplary presentation by the NYLT youth staff of their Quest for the Meaning of Leadership.
6. Have fun!

### Materials Needed

- Campfire Program Planner

### Recommended Presenter

Assigned NYLT staff members

### Recommended Location

Campfire ring

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### Recommended Facility Layout

A campfire setting is ideal, but the program can be conducted in any group setting large enough to accommodate all participants and staff comfortably. Where fire building is appropriate, a wood fire can provide atmosphere for the occasion; however, a fire is not essential to the success of the session.

## PRESENTATION OUTLINE

### Lighting the Campfire

The master of ceremonies explains how the fire lighting is being conducted, noting both the method used and the intended effects.

Even a method as simple as using matches to ignite the tinder can have elements of showmanship that will make an impression on the audience and set the tone for the program.

> ***Note***: Construct the fire lay early, while the wood and tinder are dry, and cover it with a tarp to protect it from dampness until time for the program.

### Opening

The master of ceremonies welcomes everyone and lets the audience know that this campfire is a little different than any they have experienced. It is an opening for the NYLT course. As an instructional campfire, it will also teach youth leaders how to ensure the success of campfires they have with their home units.

The master of ceremonies explains that campfires are fun, but they can be much more. They can offer entertainment, fellowship, and education. Campfires are a chance to practice leadership skills. A campfire can be an ideal time to share inspirational messages.

### Planning

The master of ceremonies explains that for a campfire program to be effective, it must be well-planned and practiced ahead of time. The NYLT Participant Notebook has a Campfire Program Planner that might be just what participants need for future campfires. If not, they can develop their own campfire program planner.

A good rule of thumb for planning campfire programs is to follow the fire. Early in the evening when the flames are lively, the program can be lively, too, involving everyone in songs, cheers, and skits. As the fire dies down, the program also can become quieter and deeper, with the most important messages coming near the end.

An effective campfire is built on four S's:

- Showmanship
- Songs
- Skits
- Stories

### *Showmanship*

Showmanship is the use of good communication skills to put sparkle and life into a gathering. Speaking well, using good body language, eye contact, etc. come together to make an effective program.

During the opening ceremony, it's showmanship that sets the tone of the whole program, but the end of a campfire is usually quiet and inspirational. The most important messages come as the embers of the fire are dying down, often including a Scoutmaster's Minute and an inspirational song. In between the opening and the closing, there will be plenty of opportunities for showmanship to add sparkle to the program through songs, skits, and stories.

### *Songs*

There are many different types of songs that are appropriate for campfires: Scout songs, quiet songs, inspirational songs, songs that require audience action. Showmanship can help involve everyone in the singing.

The master of ceremonies invites one or more NYLT staff members to come forward and model good ways to lead songs.

### *Skits*

Campfire skits can be fun and carry a message. There are plenty of ideas for skits found in Scouting America literature, other books about campfire skills, and on the internet. While these sources are good, even better are the Scouts' imaginations. Original skits can be tailor-made to fit local situations and recent events and can be extremely entertaining.

### *Stories*

Storytelling is an art that almost anyone can acquire with practice. All you need is a good imagination, an appreciation of good stories, good communication skills, and a bit of showmanship.

The campfire stories generally fall into five types:

- Ghost
- Adventure
- Humorous
- Inspirational
- High-point

Ghost Stories. This is the most-asked-for type of campfire story but one that must be handled with care. Never try to scare an audience too badly with a ghost story. We want young people to feel at home in the woods. A ghastly story or disturbing descriptions can mar that experience for youth.

Adventure Stories. Perhaps the best of all campfire stories are adventure tales that stir the imagination. The adventure can be true or fictional, or perhaps a tall tale somewhere in between. A youth can describe an overnight adventure; a leader can relate some event of

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importance from their past; a storyteller can retell the tales of explorers, heroes, scoundrels, or other real and imaginary characters.

Humorous Stories. American folklore is filled with fine and funny stories that lend themselves to being told or read around a campfire. Mark Twain's books and the stories of O. Henry, Robert Service, Bret Harte, and dozens of other American writers provide plenty of material.

Inspirational Stories. A story that inspires young people can be a very effective addition to a campfire program. There is no reason that an inspirational story cannot also have humorous elements or be an adventure tale. Look to the magazines published by Scouting America for stories, past and present, about inspiring individuals who have had a Scouting background.

High-point Stories. A campfire program should build toward a climax, an event that will top off the evening and make it a thing to remember. The high point of the program need not be elaborate, but it must be good. Among the possibilities are:

- An old-timer telling of adventure in far-off places
- A Scout telling of a jamboree experience, or tales of the Philmont trails
- A storyteller spinning a ghostly yarn
- A Scouter speaking for a quiet minute
- Someone telling the Baden-Powell story or the story of another important figure in Scouting or in local history

The master of ceremonies invites one or more NYLT staff to come forward and model good ways to tell a story.

### *Note on* Appropriateness *of Songs, Skits, and Stories*

Songs, skits, and stories should never embarrass or demean anyone or any group of people. A good test of appropriateness is to hold the skit up against the Scout Law. Any skit that is not friendly, courteous, and kind has no place in a campfire program.

Songs, skits, and stories that involve any of the following are **NOT** appropriate and are **UNACCEPTABLE** for a Scout campfire:

- Name-calling, put-downs, hazing
- References to undergarments, nudity, or bodily functions
- Cross-gender impersonation (at any point in a skit)
- Derogatory references to or stereotyping of racial, ethnic, or cultural backgrounds; economic situations; or disabilities
- Sensitive social issues such as alcohol, drugs, gangs, guns, suicide, etc.
- Wasteful, ill-mannered, or improper use of food or water including wasting food in ANY way for comedic purpose
- Inside jokes that exclude some of those present
- Cultural exclusion—emphasis on the culture or faith of part of the group while ignoring the rest of the group
- Changing lyrics to patriotic songs ("America," "America the Beautiful," "God Bless America," "The Star-spangled Banner"), hymns, or other spiritual songs
- Embarrassing ANYONE—including staff or audience members (even if they are "in on it")

- Portraying violent behavior or any behavior not in line with the Guide to Safe Scouting (e.g., pointing “guns” at each other)
- Bathroom humor
- Water skits—NO ONE gets wet in any way (includes staff, even if they are “in on it”)
- Sexual overtones
- Anything that is not in keeping with the ideals of Scouting America

**The Quest for the Meaning of Leadership**

The master of ceremonies explains that a campfire can be an opportunity to share important information. They then invite the Scoutmaster to come forward. This could include both Scoutmasters for courses using the linked troop model; logistics should be worked out during staff development.

The Scoutmaster challenges the patrols to develop their presentations of the Quest for the Meaning of Leadership. Here is some sample wording:

“This has been a busy day for everyone, and we have accomplished a great deal. We have had a very good beginning to this National Youth Leadership Training course, and I look forward to a terrific experience for everyone in the days to come.

“There are many pieces to an NYLT course—lots of presentations, activities, and adventures. While each one is important, I want us all to keep in mind the bigger picture. What we are setting out on this week is a quest—a Quest for the Meaning of Leadership.

“Leadership means different things to different people. In the days to come, each patrol will be exploring leadership in many ways. The staff will be exploring leadership, too.

“To help us make the most of this experience, I want to challenge you this week to a search, a quest . . . a Quest for the Meaning of Leadership.

“Each day your understanding of leadership is going to change. You will add new information with every presentation. As you practice leadership yourselves, you will learn a great deal about what works and what is not effective. As you watch the staff modeling different leadership styles, you will see the best that NYLT leadership has to offer.

“To help us all make the most of this quest, I’m challenging each patrol to develop a presentation that shares their understanding of the meaning of leadership. The presentation can be a skit, a song, a piece of writing, even something you construct. Each patrol will deliver its presentation on the last day of this NYLT course.

“Daily planning and working on the presentation throughout the course will encourage patrol members to agree on how their patrol will proceed and to add each day’s learning to their presentation. The quartermaster will make available a variety of materials for patrols to use in their presentations if needed.

“Each patrol member is expected to contribute to their patrol’s success during the development of the presentation. The final product should clearly reflect the combined efforts of many individual talents.

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“The Quest for the Meaning of Leadership is the great adventure of the coming days. It’s going to be fun, challenging, and full of new ideas. We are all in this together, and I’m looking forward to seeing what you all discover along the way.

“To set the tone for the quest, the staff has prepared a presentation of their own. Their quest has been a little different than yours will be. Theirs is the Quest for the Meaning of Teaching Leadership—their vision of successfully presenting the leadership concepts of the NYLT course.”

The Scoutmaster then invites NYLT staff to come forward and offer their presentation of the Quest for the Meaning of Teaching Leadership.

The staff’s presentation of their quest must be a good example of what will be expected of the patrols when they make their presentations later in the course. The staff presentation should be well-planned and interesting, and should offer real content.

**Campfire Closing**

The master of ceremonies tells participants that they have reached that time of the program when the fire is burning low and the hour is late. The presentation has been built on the four S’s of good program planning: showmanship, songs, skits, and stories. Participants will have had a great time, and perhaps will have received some seeds for thought and for long-term memories.

The master of ceremonies then calls on the Scoutmaster: “We’re going to use one more story to bring our campfire to a close. For the story, let’s use a Scoutmaster’s Minute.”

The Scoutmaster presents the Scoutmaster’s Minute:

“There is something magical about watching a flame. It can be a campfire, a candle, a lantern—the dancing light of fire draws us in and causes us to go a little deeper with our thoughts.

“What is a flame? What makes it possible? Three ingredients—heat, air, fuel.

“If I leave out any of those three, what happens? Without heat, the flame goes out. Without air, the fire is snuffed. Without fuel, the fire is starved.

“There is a fire that burns inside of each one of you, too. It is the fire of leadership. It is a flame that each of you can feel warming you. What do you need to kindle that flame of leadership, to build it from kindling and tinder into a strong, steady fire?

“As our campfire concludes, think about why you are attending this NYLT course. Dedicate yourself to making the most of the days that lie ahead. Stoke the fire of leadership burning in your soul. Let it grow and spread and light up your world.”

NATIONAL YOUTH LEADERSHIP TRAINING

# THE CAMPFIRE PROGRAM PLANNER

How to use this sheet: Be sure that every feature of this campfire program upholds Scouting's highest traditions.

1. In a campfire planning meeting, fill in the top of the Campfire Program sheet (over).
2. On the Campfire Program Planner (below), list all units and individuals who will participate in the program.
3. Write down the name, description, and type of song, stunt, or story they have planned.
4. The MC organizes songs, stunts, and stories in a good sequence considering timing, variety, smoothness, and showmanship.
5. The master-of-the-campfire makes out the Campfire Program sheet (over).
6. Copies of the program are given to all participants.

| Cheer Planner | Spot |
|---|---|
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| Song Planner | Spot |
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| Campfire Program Planner | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Group or Individual | Description | Type | Spot |
| Opening | | | |
| Closing | | | |
| Headliner | Main event | | |
| Song leader | | | |
| Cheerleader | | | |

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# CAMPFIRE PROGRAM

Place _____

Date _____

Time _____

Camp director's approval: _____

_____

Campers notified _____ Area set up by _____

Campfire planning meeting _____ _____

M. C. _____ Campfire built by _____

Song leader _____ Fire put out by _____

Cheermaster _____ Cleanup by _____

| Spot | Title of Stunt, Song, or Story | By _____ | Time |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Opening—and firelighting | | |
| 2 | Greeting—introduction | M.C. | |
| 3 | Sing— Yell— | | |
| 4 | | | |
| 5 | | | |
| 6 | | | |
| 7 | | | |
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| 17 | | | |
| 18 | | | |
| 19 | | | |
| 20 | | | |
| 21 | | | |
| 22 | Closing | | |

2

# Day One: Cracker Barrel and Songfest

### Time Allowed

45 Minutes

### Teaching Format

Troop activity

### Learning Objectives

As a result of this session, participants will be able to do the following:

1. Enjoy fellowship with staff and participants.
2. Feel included in the course and the activity.
3. Understand how to lead others in singing songs.

### Materials Needed

- Cracker barrel items (to be determined locally)
- Course songbook or photocopies of lyrics for songfest

### Recommended Presenter

NYLT staff

### Recommended Location

Appropriate troop area

## PRESENTATION OUTLINE

Depending on how late the Model Campfire goes, the staff may choose to host a cracker barrel (sharing of a snack) and sing-along/songfest.

A typical plan for this time together is to provide a snack for staff and participants. The snack could be popcorn, cheese and crackers, ice cream, or anything else appropriate for the location and that works with the course budget.

For the songfest, the staff should select and practice songs that they are able to lead participants in singing. Staff are encouraged to select songs from the course songbook, which allows staff and participants to follow along if they do not know a particular song. This supports the goal of everyone feeling included.

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